

INDUSTRY TREND ANALYSIS

Resilience reshapes operations

Structural · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

Companies are building multi-hub, route-switchable, verifiable supply networks rather than pursuing a uniform retreat into near-shoring.

4.6% to 1.9%

WTO baseline shift in merchandise-trade volume growth from 2025 to the 2026 forecast. ^[1]

31 vs 13

OECD economies screening inbound investment in 2023 versus 2010, as cited in the Brief archive. ^[2]

2.9% annually

long-term global trade growth cited in the Weekly Brief, alongside a fundamental realignment of routes. ^[3]

What is changing - and why it matters

Industrial networks are being rewired rather than uniformly regionalized. Companies need multiple viable hubs, route flexibility and visibility into critical upstream dependencies. The WTO evidence shows trade can continue growing while routes and sector patterns change, so a blanket near-shoring strategy may sacrifice economics without creating real resilience.

Executive implication

Industrial networks are being rewired rather than uniformly regionalized. Companies need multiple viable hubs, route flexibility and visibility into critical upstream dependencies. The WTO evidence shows trade can continue growing while routes and sector patterns change, so a blanket near-shoring strategy may sacrifice economics without creating real resilience.

Action agenda

- Segment inputs by criticality, substitutability and recovery time.
- Design multi-hub and route-switching options for the most exposed flows.
- Measure resilience through time-to-recover and earnings at risk.

What could change the view

- Policy barriers broaden into additional technologies or inputs.
- Duplicated capacity raises cost without shortening recovery time.

Selected evidence

[1] Authoritative research · WTO · 2026-03-19 · Global Trade Outlook and Statistics — March 2026 · p. 4

[2] Weekly Brief · 2024-06-24 · How to Face Rising Geopolitical Risk

[3] Weekly Brief · 2025-01-14 · Navigating the New Dynamics of Global Trade

[4] Weekly Brief · 2025-08-28 · Reflections from India—A Country Defining Its Future

[5] Authoritative research · WTO · 2025-12-15 · Global Value Chain Development Report 2025: Rewiring GVCs in a Changing Global Economy

[6] Authoritative research · UNIDO · 2025-11-26 · Industrial Development Report 2026

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.